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Course code:CSA1007

Course Name: Software Engineering

Case Study Analysis Report

Title: Intelligent Nuclear Power Plant Monitoring Platform

1. Understand the Problem Statement

1.1 Problem Explanation

Nuclear power plants require continuous monitoring of reactor conditions to ensure safe and reliable operation. Traditional monitoring systems mainly depend on human operators and isolated monitoring devices, making it difficult to detect equipment failures or abnormal reactor conditions in real time. Delays in identifying issues can lead to equipment damage, radiation leakage, operational shutdowns, or safety hazards.

The proposed Intelligent Nuclear Power Plant Monitoring Platform is a software-based system that integrates IoT sensors, Artificial Intelligence (AI), Machine Learning (ML), and real-time analytics to monitor reactor conditions, detect anomalies, predict equipment failures, monitor radiation levels, and support emergency response.

1.2 Objectives

The objectives of the proposed system are:

1. Monitor reactor conditions continuously.
2. Detect operational anomalies in real time.
3. Predict equipment failures before breakdown.
4. Track radiation levels throughout the plant.
5. Support emergency response during abnormal situations.
6. Generate compliance and safety analytics reports.

1.3 Scope

The proposed system covers:

- Reactor temperature monitoring
- Pressure monitoring
- Radiation monitoring
- Equipment health monitoring
- AI-based anomaly detection
- Predictive maintenance
- Alert and notification management
- Regulatory compliance reporting
- Emergency response support
- Secure data storage and visualization

The system does not control the reactor directly but assists operators in decision-making.

2. Stakeholder Analysis

2.1 Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role
Plant Operators	Monitor plant operations and respond to alerts
Control Room Engineers	Supervise reactor performance
Maintenance Team	Repair faulty equipment
Safety Officers	Ensure plant safety standards
Regulatory Authorities	Verify compliance with nuclear regulations
Plant Management	Make operational decisions
Emergency Response Team	Handle emergency situations
Software Developers	Develop and maintain the platform
Cybersecurity Team	Protect system against cyber attacks

2.2 Roles and Responsibilities

Plant Operators

- Monitor dashboards

- Respond to alarms
- Perform routine inspections

Engineers

- Analyze reactor performance
- Validate system recommendations
- Manage operational parameters

Maintenance Team

- Replace faulty equipment
- Perform preventive maintenance

Safety Officers

- Monitor radiation exposure
- Verify safety compliance

Regulatory Authorities

- Audit reports
- Inspect safety records

Software Developers

- Develop monitoring software
- Fix software bugs
- Upgrade system

Cybersecurity Team

- Monitor network security
- Prevent unauthorized access

2.3 Challenges

- Huge amount of sensor data
- Difficulty in detecting hidden failures
- Human error during monitoring
- Equipment aging
- Radiation safety risks

- Cybersecurity threats
- Compliance with nuclear regulations
- High system reliability requirements

3. Current System Analysis

3.1 Existing System

The existing monitoring system includes:

- SCADA systems
- Manual inspection
- Individual monitoring devices
- Alarm systems
- Periodic maintenance

3.2 Strengths

- Proven technology
- Reliable sensor networks
- Standard safety mechanisms
- Well-established operating procedures

3.3 Limitations

- Limited predictive capabilities
- Mostly reactive maintenance
- Manual data analysis
- High operator workload
- Delayed anomaly detection
- Limited data integration

3.4 Problems/Gaps

- No intelligent failure prediction

- Difficult to analyze large datasets
- Lack of AI-based decision support
- Delayed emergency response
- Separate monitoring systems
- Limited automation

4. Proposed Software Solution

4.1 Proposed Solution

Develop an **AI-enabled Nuclear Power Plant Monitoring Platform** integrating:

- IoT Sensors
- Machine Learning
- Cloud Database
- Real-time Dashboard
- Predictive Analytics
- Alert Management
- Compliance Reporting

The platform continuously collects sensor data, analyzes it using AI models, predicts equipment failures, and alerts operators instantly.

4.2 Functional Modules

Module 1: Sensor Data Collection

- Collect temperature
- Pressure
- Radiation
- Vibration
- Coolant flow

Module 2: Real-Time Monitoring

Displays:

- Reactor temperature
- Pressure
- Radiation levels
- Equipment status

Module 3: AI Anomaly Detection

Detects:

- Abnormal reactor conditions
- Equipment malfunction
- Radiation leakage
- Sensor failure

Module 4: Predictive Maintenance

Predicts:

- Pump failure
- Valve failure
- Cooling system faults
- Generator maintenance

Module 5: Radiation Monitoring

Tracks:

- Radiation zones
- Exposure levels
- Worker safety

Module 6: Emergency Management

Provides:

- Automatic alerts
- Emergency recommendations
- Incident logging

- Evacuation support

Module 7: Compliance Analytics

Generates:

- Safety reports
- Regulatory reports
- Maintenance history
- Radiation logs

4.3 Functional Requirements

- User login
- Real-time monitoring
- Sensor data collection
- Alert generation
- AI anomaly detection
- Equipment prediction
- Radiation monitoring
- Report generation
- Dashboard visualization
- Data backup

4.4 Non-Functional Requirements

- High reliability
- High availability (24×7)
- Scalability
- Security
- Performance
- Maintainability
- Fault tolerance

- Usability
- Accuracy
- Data integrity

4.5 Software Engineering Principles

Modularity

Separate modules:

- Monitoring
- AI
- Reports
- Alerts
- Security

Scalability

Supports:

- Additional sensors
- Multiple reactors
- More users

Maintainability

- Easy software updates
- Modular coding
- Documentation

Reliability

- Fault-tolerant architecture
- Backup servers
- Redundant sensors

Usability

- User-friendly dashboard
- Simple navigation
- Visual charts

Security

- Role-based access
- Encryption
- Multi-factor authentication
- Secure communication
- Audit logs

5. SDLC / Framework Justification

Selected Model

Spiral SDLC Model

Why Spiral Model?

Nuclear power plant software is:

- High-risk
- Safety-critical
- Requires continuous risk assessment
- Requires multiple testing cycles
- Needs frequent validation

The Spiral Model focuses on risk analysis at every phase, making it ideal for this project.

Advantages**

- Continuous risk management
- Early error detection
- Easy requirement refinement

- Customer feedback
- High software quality
- Better documentation

Project Development Support

The Spiral Model supports:

- Requirement analysis
- Prototype development
- Risk analysis
- Testing
- Validation
- Maintenance
- Continuous improvement

6. Expected Outcomes and Limitations

6.1 Expected Benefits

- Improved nuclear plant safety
- Early fault detection
- Reduced operational risk
- Lower maintenance cost
- Better emergency response
- Reduced downtime
- Improved regulatory compliance
- Accurate decision-making
- Higher equipment life

6.2 Challenge Resolution

Challenge	Solution
Equipment failure	Predictive maintenance
Radiation risk	Real-time monitoring
Human error	AI-assisted decision support
Delayed response	Instant alerts
Data overload	Intelligent analytics
Compliance	Automatic report generation

6.3 Risks and Limitations

- High implementation cost
- Complex AI model training
- Cybersecurity threats
- Sensor failures
- Network outages
- High maintenance cost
- Regulatory approval requirements
- Dependence on accurate sensor data

6.4 Future Enhancements

- Digital Twin technology
- Edge Computing
- Blockchain for secure records
- Advanced Deep Learning models
- Drone-based plant inspection
- Autonomous maintenance robots
- Mobile monitoring application
- Cloud-based analytics
- Explainable AI (XAI)
- Integration with national emergency management systems

Expected Deliverables

1. Case Study Analysis Report

✔ Completed

2. Problem Analysis

- Reactor monitoring challenges
- Safety risks
- Equipment failures
- Radiation monitoring

3. Stakeholder Analysis

- Plant operators
- Engineers
- Maintenance staff
- Safety officers
- Regulators
- Developers
- Management

4. Current System Analysis

- Existing SCADA-based monitoring
- Strengths
- Weaknesses
- Gaps

5. Proposed Software Solution

- AI-enabled intelligent monitoring platform
- Functional modules
- Requirements
- Software engineering principles

6. SDLC Justification

- Spiral Model selected due to safety-critical and risk-driven development.

7. Expected Outcomes and Limitations

- Enhanced safety
- Reduced downtime
- Better compliance
- Improved decision support
- Future enhancements identified